

IRELAND

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Ireland
Short Form	Ireland
Capital	Dublin
Region (UN)	Western Europe and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Parliamentary Democracy
Head of State	President Michael D. Higgins
Head of Government	Taoiseach Simon Harris
Currency	Euro (€)
UN Member Since	14 December 1955
MUN Standing	Ireland is widely recognized as a respected voice for peacebuilding, multilateralism, human rights, and development. It has served on the Security Council and is active in humanitarian and gender equality agendas.



Book Recommendations

Title	Author(s)	Why It's Relevant
<i>Ireland and the United Nations: Fifty Years of Engagement</i>	John Doyle	Detailed history of Ireland's participation in the UN and multilateral diplomacy.
<i>Irish Foreign Policy</i>	Ben Tonra	Covers Ireland's global positioning, neutrality, peacekeeping, and development aid.
<i>Ireland, Neutrality and the EU: The Role of Human Rights and</i>	Michael Holmes	Explores how Ireland balances neutrality and active diplomacy—key

<i>Global Law</i>		for MUN context.
<i>The United Nations and Ireland: Theory and Practice</i>	Noel Dorr	In-depth analysis of Ireland's engagement with major UN bodies.
<i>Small States and Shelter Theory: Ireland in the International System</i>	Baldur Thorhallsson	Explains how Ireland uses multilateralism to amplify its global influence.

Ireland: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Department of Foreign Affairs – Human Rights Unit	https://www.dfa.ie/our-role-policies/international-priorities/human-rights/	Ireland's main policy page for multilateral human rights engagement including HRC.
Irish Human Rights and Equality Commission (IHREC)	https://www.ihrec.ie/	Independent national institution working with UNHRC mechanisms, produces parallel reports.
Universal Periodic Review – Ireland	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ie-index	Most recent UPR report by and about Ireland including issues raised by other states.
Freedom House – Ireland Profile	https://freedomhouse.org/country/ireland/freedom-world/2023	Civil liberties and political rights score relevant to human rights assessments.

Amnesty International – Ireland Country Report	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/ireland/report-ireland/	Human rights issues in policing, refugee rights, abortion access, and freedom of expression.
Human Rights Watch – Ireland Coverage	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/ireland	Reports on key rights issues: housing, minority protection, asylum.
Council of Europe – ECRI Reports on Ireland	https://www.coe.int/en/web/european-commission-against-racism-and-intolerance/ireland	Evaluations of racial equality and anti-discrimination enforcement.
UN OHCHR – Ireland Voting and Participation	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/regular-sessions	Provides records of how Ireland voted or co-sponsored resolutions.

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – Ireland	OHCHR UPR Ireland	Central documents: reports, recommendations, state responses (ohchr.org , developmenteducation.ie)
UPR Info – Ireland	UPR Info	NGO, UN, and state stakeholder submissions
UPR Working Group Report (2011)	DevelopmentEducation.ie	First UPR report with implementation recommendations
OHCHR Press – UPR Review Announcement	OHCHR Press	Pre-review summary of Ireland's participation
Irish NHRI on UPR	IHREC Page	Role of National Human Rights Commission
Freedom in the World 2024	Freedom House	Civil & political freedom assessment

Freedom on the Net 2024	Freedom House PDF	Online freedoms & digital rights
Amnesty: Data privacy law critique	Amnesty Ireland	Surveillance concerns
Human Rights in Ireland – Amnesty	Amnesty Ireland	Surveillance and legal rights concerns
UNHCR – Ireland country overview	UNHCR US Page	Refugee/asylum-seeker rights overview
UNHCR Ireland HELP Portal	Help UNHCR	How-to guide for asylum applicants
UNHCR Resettlement FAQs	UNHCR Resettlement	Info on entering through resettlement
UNHCR – NGOs in Ireland	UNHCR NGOs List	Irish organisations supporting refugees
Irish Refugee Council resources	IRC Site	Legal & social support for refugees
Doras NGO profile	Doras NGO Page	Advocacy on direct provision & integration
Nasc NGO profile	Nasc	Cork-based migrant & refugee legal support
Digital migration risks	Amnesty Migration Tech	Examines tech in migrant surveillance
Privacy Rights report N. Ireland	Amnesty NI	Police surveillance of lawyers/journalists

Unique Aspects of Ireland's UNHRC Engagement

1. **Active UPR Civil Society Involvement** – NGOs like IHREC, FLAC, and IRC are doing a fantastic job engaging with the UPR process.
2. **Refugee & Asylum Focus** – The UNHCR has been actively present since 1998, utilizing tools such as the HELP portal, the IPAS unit, and the IRCO support system.
3. **Data & Protest Surveillance Scrutiny** – Amnesty International is raising concerns about facial recognition technology and recent rollbacks in data

protection that are negatively impacting the rights of protesters.

4. **Strong Online Freedom Scores** – Ranked as “Free” with impressive online rights scores, promoting digital expression.
 5. **Integration NGOs Widely Active** – Doras, Nasc, Integration Centre plays a crucial role in shaping policy and legal pathways.
 6. **Direct Provision System Oversight** – Dive into the discussions and legal evaluations surrounding migrant housing and reception under IPAS.
 7. **Privacy Watch in Northern Ireland Context** – The UK's surveillance issues are prompting a reevaluation of policies across borders.
 8. **Institutional Transparency in UPR** – Full access to submitted documents, stakeholder additions, including mid-term review contributions.
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